

SWEET AND CHILI PEPPERS

Capsicum annuum Longum Group and *C. annuum* Grossum Group

Amazingly diverse, peppers are available in a vivid range of shades, from green to red, purple, yellow, black, and orange. They can also be round, barrel-shaped, pointed, or flat. In addition to being good to eat—either sweet or intensely fiery—they are often highly ornamental, and are easy to grow as long as they have plenty of warmth.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW/PLANT				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Peppers will thrive in containers, as long as these are large enough to sustain them and contain fertile soil. Before planting, dig in plenty of well-rotted manure or compost, and apply some general fertilizer.

Sow seed in early spring. Scatter it thinly and cover with a thin layer of soil; it will need a minimum temperature of around 64–77°F (18–25°C). Transfer the seedlings into individual pots as soon as they are large enough to be handled. They need warmth and light, must not get crowded, and will need liquid fertilizer when roots appear at the bottom of the container.

When the seedlings have filled their pots with roots, plant them



Plant peppers out after hardening off.

in a greenhouse or move them outside and protect with cloches or fleece, if necessary. Allow 15–18 in (38–45 cm) between plants.

CROP CARE

Water to keep the root zone moist. Plants usually branch naturally, but you will also need to pinch out the growing tips to induce bushy growth. Support plants with stakes and string,